

Each team is scored out of 100 points across three categories: Written Report (40), Portfolio Performance (30), and Trade Quality / Process (30). The judging panel will score the quality of a team's reasoning and process, not just the outcome of their trades.

Portfolio Performance and Trade Quality rubrics will be determined through each team's StockTrak activity log where possible, as well as may result in added points if ambiguous decisions are well-reasoned in the report. The judging panel will rate each team's performance independently before comparing notes with other judges.

1. Written Report — 40 points

Criterion	Points	What Judges Look For
Investment Thesis	10	Clear, logical reasoning for each major holding: why this stock or sector, why now. Doesn't need to be sophisticated, only needs to show reasoning and be well-supported.
Research & Evidence Used	10	How much research was done prior to making decisions? Shows the team looked at something real, such as news, earnings, sector trends, comparisons, and didn't base their decisions off on a whim.
Risk Awareness	8	Identifies what could go wrong with their positions, not just why they'll win. Diversification reasoning counts here.
Adaptation & Reflection	7	Did the team adjust strategy mid-competition, and can they explain why? If not, why not? This rubric measures how well the team shows learning and the ability to adapt to the volatile market(s).
Clarity & Structure	5	How organized, easy to read, and to what extent does it follow the criteria of the written report rubric. This is about the presentation of the report.

2. Portfolio Performance — 30 points

Criterion	Points	What Judges Look For
Total Return	15	Raw portfolio performance over the 4-week competition, ranked relative to other teams.
Risk-Adjusted Return	10	To what extent was contingency accounted for in trades? This criteria rewards teams who performed well without reckless risk-taking.
Diversification	5	Portfolio is not dangerously concentrated in a single stock or sector.

3. Trade Quality / Process — 30 points

Criterion	Points	What Judges Look For
Trade Rationale Consistency	10	Actual trades match what the report claims the strategy was. This prevents random trades and contradicting the stated thesis.
Frequency & Discipline	10	Not wildly overtrading out of panic, and not completely inactive after week one. Judged from StockTrak activity logs.
Use of Available Tools	10	Did the team use stop-losses, limit orders, sector research tools, etc. Measures engagement with the StockTrak platform beyond a single initial pick.